

Overview

PondLite is an application I am designing with a .NET backend using C#. It is focused on creating a low/no obligation space where couples can connect with each other throughout the day in small, meaningful ways. PondLite should feel like a fun, safe, private relationship space rather than a productivity app or task tracker. The goal is to help both partners feel seen, cared for, and emotionally present without pressure, punishment, or heavy commitment.

Each couple shares a private relationship space, referred to in the user interface as their Pond. Users in the same Pond are PondMates. All emotionally personal content, such as daily check-ins, notes, reminders/ribbits, discussion responses, frog states, and AI-generated suggestions, belongs to that private relationship space and should only be accessible to the users connected to that Pond.

The application will include daily emotional check-ins, optional relationship-oriented discussion prompts, gentle reminders/ribbits, a bug-themed gift system, frog reactivity based on emotional state, and an optional Smart Connection Assistant. The Smart Connection Assistant will provide gentle suggestions for care actions, possible messages, or discussion prompts, but it will not make decisions for the user or pressure either partner to act.

Early development will focus on building the backend, frontend, and a private deployment for Brandon and Michelle using a Raspberry Pi and Tailscale. A later public version would require migration to a cloud-hosted environment, stronger production security, privacy policies, account deletion, backups, monitoring, and App Store/Play Store readiness.

Features (first split):

- Login/Logout system
- Account creation
- Private Pond/relationship space
- PondMate connection/invitation
- Daily emotional check-in
- Daily relationship-oriented discussion
- Ribbits / gentle reminders
- Bug-themed gift system
- Frog reactivity and emotional reflection
- Smart Connection Assistant for care suggestions, message ideas, and optional discussion support

Later Features:

- Pond decorations
- Frog interactions
- Wandering frogs
- Sound
- Child frogs
- Marry feature

- Pond Rhythm Rewards, such as bonus bugs or small visual flair for consistent shared use
- More advanced AI personalization
- Memory/archive features
- Public cloud deployment
- More...

Note: Later reward features should remain non-punitive. PondLite should not remove progress, shame users, or create pressure for missing a day. Any consistency rewards should be framed as gentle Pond activity or bonus rewards rather than streaks that reset to zero.

Terms:

Backend/domain term:

Relationship

Frontend/user-facing term:

Pond

User-facing partner term:

PondMate

Feature term:

Ribbit

A Relationship represents the private backend data boundary for a couple. In the user interface, this Relationship is called a Pond.